

# Yousician Strategic Environment Mapping

A brief-led ecosystem report: who influences music learning, who appears successful, who shapes music as a hobby, and which actors define Yousician's strategic environment.

96

**ecosystem records**

The map covers companies, creators, institutions, capital, media and market signals.

4

**key players**

The initial shortlist is intentionally small; long-tail records stay available for triage.

49

**market moves**

Last-24-month news-grade moves answer who made the news for what.

13

**brief categories**

Every requested category is visible as part of the ecosystem, not hidden in appendix.

7

**success surfaces**

Success is read across app, repertoire, AI utility, trust, community and hardware funnels.

6

**internal context rows**

Static Yousician user and market context is included as grounding, not live metric data.

10

**top actors**

The executive read starts from the actors most likely to shape the market around Yousician.

6

**free data routes**

Non-paid public sources are documented separately from credentialed performance data.

## Executive Summary

The environment around Yousician is not only a direct-competitor market. It is shaped by learning apps, hardware brands, song and practice platforms, teachers and education bodies, creator educators, hobby software, AI tools, rights owners, investors, media and cultural demand drivers.

The readout is structured around the requested ecosystem map, a small initial key-player shortlist, brief-style one-pagers, database, relationship fields and guiding-question answers. It is intended to make the stakeholder landscape legible before moving into source detail.

**Latest source-skim update:** Suno announced more than \$400M in Series D funding at a \$5.4B post-money valuation on June 3, 2026. This strengthens the conclusion that AI music creation is a market-structure force, not only a product feature.

Input note: Appfigures performance metrics and internal relationship fields are prepared as separate support files because they require credentialed or Yousician-internal inputs.

# What the brief asks, answered first

## 1. Who influences the future of music learning? Who is successful?

Start with the four agreed profiles: Simply for direct-app benchmarking, Ultimate Guitar for repertoire/practice power, Duolingo for consumer-learning mechanics, and Fender for hardware trust and beginner route options. Other success surfaces stay in the long-tail database until triage confirms priority.

## 3. Who influences the future strategic environment around Yousician?

AI companies, rights owners, app-based competitors, hardware brands, creators, publishers, investors, awards/funding bodies, media and education benchmarks jointly shape the field around Yousician.

## 2. Who influences the future of music as a hobby?

TikTok, YouTube, Spotify, artists, song libraries, creator tools, AI generation tools, instrument brands, retailers and cultural moments influence what people want to play, make and share before they enter formal learning.

# Static internal research grounding for how to read the ecosystem

Static Yousician user/market context by User Insights, last reviewed 2026-06-04; based on internal meta-analyses for Yousician users, GuitarTuna users and market research. Live Confluence research database was not queried in this packaging pass.

| Context Area            | Internal Signal                                                                                                                                                         | Strategic Implication                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Yousician users         | Yousician users are usually early in their guitar journey and want a guided, personalised path, timely feedback and eventually their favourite songs.                   | Direct learning benchmarks should be read through beginner guidance, feedback, motivation and song relevance, not only feature breadth.     |
| GuitarTuna users        | GuitarTuna users are more self-guided. They want independence, songs, chords, tools and optional feedback rather than a fixed path.                                     | The ecosystem map needs song, chord, tab, utility and self-guided practice surfaces alongside formal learning apps.                         |
| Song-led jobs           | Across skill levels, important guitar jobs cluster around learning chords, transitions, song sections, strumming patterns and playing songs from memory.                | Ultimate Guitar, Songsterr, MuseScore, Chordify, YouTube and AI song-practice tools are core habit surfaces, not appendix-only comparables. |
| Starting and restarting | People start or restart because of love of music, feel-good free time, the guitar dream, access to a guitar, or emotional life moments.                                 | Hardware brands, retailers, creators and emotional beginner UX are strategically relevant because they shape re-entry before app choice.    |
| Market awareness        | Internal market context says the category has low overall awareness, lacks strong brands and lacks a clear leader beyond YouTube as a default free source.              | The opportunity is not only to beat app competitors; it is also to make the category easier, less intimidating and more clearly branded.    |
| Known competitor read   | Simply Guitar is strong on emotional UX and song-focused courses; Ultimate Guitar owns a large chord/tab library but can feel cluttered; YouTube is free but uncurated. | Success should be read as a mix of emotional onboarding, repertoire access, guidance quality and reduced user research burden.              |

# Successful actors by success type

This answers the success question without pretending that missing Appfigures data can identify app revenue/download winners. Ecosystem influence can already be read by surface; app-performance ranking is the remaining credentialed input.

| Success Type                  | Actors                           | Evidence                                                                                                    | Caveat                                                                        |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Direct app benchmark          | Simply / JoyTunes                | Closest app-learning benchmark for onboarding, motivation, subscription learning and beginner conversion.   | Appfigures still required for revenue/download ranking.                       |
| Repertoire / practice surface | Ultimate Guitar / Muse Group     | Strong repertoire ownership and song-intent surface around tabs, chords and practice habits.                | Use as ecosystem influence, not revenue ranking.                              |
| AI practice utility           | Music.AI / Moises                | Stems, isolation, transcription and practice utility connect AI directly to playing and creation workflows. | Mobile performance still requires credentialed validation.                    |
| AI creation signal            | Suno                             | Funding, rights debate and product visibility make AI music creation a market-structure force.              | Not a learning-app performance comparable.                                    |
| Hobby creation / community    | BandLab / Splice                 | Creator workflows and communities shape participation beyond formal learning.                               | Compare by creator ecosystem strength, not lesson UX.                         |
| Trust and curriculum layer    | ABRSM / Trinity / School of Rock | Certification, teacher trust and education infrastructure shape parent/learner confidence.                  | Success is credibility and reach, not app-store metrics.                      |
| Hardware funnel               | Fender / Gibson / Yamaha         | Brands and retailers influence instrument access, bundles and beginner pathways.                            | Hardware distribution and learning-app performance should be read separately. |

# The 10 actors or clusters that should lead the executive read

These actors are prioritized by ecosystem influence. They are not app-performance-ranked because that requires the Appfigures input.

| Rank | Actor Or Cluster                                 | Primary Influence Layer                                       | Guiding Question Answered               | Priority Reason                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Suno                                             | AI creation and rights risk                                   | Music as a hobby; strategic environment | Suno is the clearest signal that music participation can move from learning an instrument to prompting, generating and sharing music, while also triggering rights and licensing risk. |
| 2    | Music.AI / Moises                                | AI practice utility and creator tooling                       | Music learning; music as a hobby        | Moises connects AI directly to practice utility: stems, isolation, transcription and creator workflow reduce friction between song discovery and playing.                              |
| 3    | Simply / JoyTunes                                | Direct app-based learning benchmark                           | Music learning; who is successful       | Simply is the closest mobile learning benchmark for onboarding, motivation, subscription learning and beginner conversion.                                                             |
| 4    | Ultimate Guitar / Muse Group                     | Song-practice habit and repertoire ownership                  | Music learning; music as a hobby        | Ultimate Guitar controls a major song-to-practice surface: tabs, chords, community and repeated practice intent.                                                                       |
| 5    | BandLab                                          | Creation community and hobby expansion                        | Music as a hobby; strategic environment | BandLab represents the path where hobbyists create, collaborate and publish rather than only learn or practice.                                                                        |
| 6    | TikTok / YouTube music discovery                 | Discovery, demand creation and creator trust                  | Music as a hobby; music learning        | These platforms shape what beginners want to play and which creators they trust before a learning product is considered.                                                               |
| 7    | Fender / Gibson / Yamaha hardware ecosystems     | Instrument access, bundles and branded learning funnels       | Music learning; strategic environment   | Hardware brands can turn instrument purchase, setup, app onboarding and lesson subscription into one beginner journey.                                                                 |
| 8    | Splice                                           | Paid creator tools and rights-aware workflow                  | Music as a hobby; strategic environment | Splice shows that hobby participation can become paid creator workflow, sample access and production learning.                                                                         |
| 9    | ABRSM / Trinity / School of Rock education layer | Trust, curriculum, certification and teacher/parent influence | Music learning; strategic environment   | Education bodies and school networks shape credibility, progression, parent trust and teacher recommendations.                                                                         |
| 10   | Spotify / labels / rights infrastructure         | Rights, artist data, repertoire and AI governance             | Music as a hobby; strategic environment | Rights owners and music platforms set the permission, repertoire and artist-authenticity context for AI, songs and learning content.                                                   |

# What the ecosystem currently looks like

## 1 / VERY CLOSE

### Direct learning and practice apps

Simply, Flowkey, Skoove, Fender Play, Gibson App, Rocksmith+, Guitar Tricks, Pickup Music

These players compete or benchmark directly on beginner learning, practice feedback, lessons, song-led curricula and subscription habits.

## 2 / CLOSE

### Song and repertoire ownership

Ultimate Guitar, MuseScore, Songsterr, Chordify, Chord ai, YouTube

Song demand and repertoire access shape what learners actually practice and why they return.

## 3 / CLOSE / PARTNERSHIP SURFACE

### Hardware-backed beginner funnels

Fender, Gibson, Yamaha, Positive Grid, Donner, retailers

Instrument purchase is a major entry point; brands can bundle apps, lessons, setup and accessories into the beginner journey.

## 4 / CLOSE / ADJACENT UTILITY

### AI practice utility

Moises, Chord ai, Chordify AI features, transcription/stem tools

These tools reduce the distance from song discovery to usable practice assets such as stems, chords and transcriptions.

## 5 / ADJACENT HOBBY EXPANSION

### Creation and production tools

BandLab, Splice, GarageBand, Ableton, FL Studio, Soundtrap

Learners increasingly move from playing to creating, remixing, producing and sharing.

## 6 / ADJACENT TRUST AND ACQUISITION LAYER

### Creator educators and media demand

JustinGuitar, Marty Music, Drumeo, Pianote, Rick Beato, Paul Davids, Guitar World, MusicRadar, MusicTech

Creators and media shape trust, song demand, lesson expectations and the beginner's mental model of progress.

## 7 / TRUST / BENCHMARK LAYER

### Formal education and teacher networks

ABRSM, Trinity, RSL Awards, MTNA, Berklee Online, School of Rock, teacher platforms

These bodies influence standards, credibility, parent trust, teacher recommendations and progression pathways.

## 8 / STRATEGIC ENVIRONMENT

### AI creation, rights and platform governance

Suno, Udio, ElevenLabs Music, labels, RIAA, Spotify, YouTube, TikTok

AI generation and rights governance reshape what music participation, repertoire use and content authenticity mean.

Capital, awards and public funding

VC/growth funds, strategic investors, Business Finland, Horizon Europe, awards ecosystems

Funding and awards indicate where the market sees momentum and where non-dilutive or credibility opportunities may exist.

Brief-category coverage

| Brief Category                                      | Coverage                                                     | Key Examples                                                                                                    | Output Location                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Music learning apps and platforms                   | 15 database records / 1 key players                          | Simply / Flowkey / Fender Play / Rocksmith+                                                                     | Deck, report, database, Appfigures data request |
| Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors   | 11 database records / 1 key players                          | Fender / Gibson / Yamaha / Positive Grid                                                                        | Ecosystem map, key players, database            |
| Teachers, schools and music education organizations | 17 education rows plus key-player coverage                   | ABRSM / Trinity / School of Rock / Berklee Online                                                               | Trust infrastructure section, database          |
| Music hobby software ecosystem                      | 26 database records / 1 key players                          | Ultimate Guitar / MuseScore / Songsterr / BandLab                                                               | Ecosystem map, hobby journey, key players       |
| Wider education and self-improvement ecosystem      | Covered through wider education rows and benchmark platforms | Duolingo / Berklee Online / classroom music platforms                                                           | Education category coverage, database           |
| Investors active in the space                       | 22 investor rows                                             | Menlo Ventures / Lightspeed Venture Partners / Matrix Partners / NVentures                                      | Capital and recognition section, database       |
| Influencers, creators and educators                 | 26 creator/educator rows                                     | JustinGuitar / Marty Music / Rick Beato / Paul Davids                                                           | Trust infrastructure section, database          |
| Media, publishers and cultural drivers              | 28 media/culture rows                                        | Guitar World / MusicRadar / MusicTech / Billboard                                                               | Music-as-hobby and media/culture sections       |
| AI companies and AI initiatives                     | 9 database records / 0 key players                           | Suno / Music.AI-Moises / Udio / ElevenLabs                                                                      | AI and rights layer, key players, timeline      |
| Awards                                              | 12 award rows                                                | Apple Design Awards / Google Play Best Of / The Webby Awards / The EdTech Awards                                | Capital and recognition section, database       |
| Funding                                             | 12 funding rows                                              | Business Finland R&D and piloting / Business Finland Co-Innovation / EIC Accelerator / Horizon Europe Cluster 2 | Capital and recognition section, database       |
| Last 24 months on the market                        | 49 curated news-grade moves                                  | Funding / M&A / AI launches / rights and policy / partnerships                                                  | Last-24-months market moves section             |

# Last 24 months: curated market moves

The main table uses Grade A/B items only. Appendix-only rows are retained as context but should not carry the main narrative.

| Date       | Move Type                  | Player Or Signal         | What Happened                                                                                                          | Why It Matters For Yousician                                                                                      | Confidence | News Grade |
|------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|
| 2024-06-24 | AI rights / litigation     | Suno / Udio / RIAA       | Major record companies filed copyright infringement cases against Suno and Udio.                                       | AI music moved from novelty to rights, licensing and leadership-level risk.                                       | High       | A          |
| 2024-08-01 | Policy / AI governance     | European Union AI Act    | The EU AI Act entered into force, with transparency rules for AI-generated content and GPAI obligations phasing in.    | EU AI transparency and copyright compliance expectations matter for AI-enabled music learning and creation tools. | High       | A          |
| 2024-09-24 | Platform move              | TikTok Music             | TikTok announced it would shut down TikTok Music and focus on music discovery in the main TikTok app.                  | Music discovery power remains in social platforms even when full streaming products retreat.                      | Medium     | B          |
| 2024-09-25 | Hardware + software bundle | Duolingo / Loog          | Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.                                     | Consumer learning platforms are testing physical beginner bundles.                                                | Medium     | B          |
| 2024-10-01 | Education / apps           | ABRSM                    | ABRSM's 2024 impact report quantified global exams, qualifications and teacher support.                                | Formal assessment bodies still shape parent, teacher and serious-learner trust.                                   | High       | A          |
| 2024-11-12 | AI product experiment      | YouTube Dream Track      | YouTube tested AI restyling of licensed songs for Shorts using Dream Track technology.                                 | Short-form video platforms are turning licensed music into editable creator material.                             | Medium     | B          |
| 2024-11-15 | Marketplace closure        | Microsoft TakeLessons    | Microsoft's TakeLessons marketplace closed, with account access ending in November 2024.                               | Online lesson marketplaces remain fragile; teacher acquisition and continuity are strategic surfaces.             | High       | A          |
| 2025-01-15 | Publishing / rights        | Muse Group / Hal Leonard | Muse Group unified Hal Leonard US and Europe into a global publishing operation.                                       | Song rights, notation, tabs and learning content are becoming more ecosystem-controlled.                          | Medium     | B          |
| 2025-01-22 | Funding / AI utility       | Music.AI / Moises        | Music.AI raised a \$40M Series A and reported Moises at 50M users.                                                     | AI practice utilities have meaningful reach and investor momentum.                                                | High       | A          |
| 2025-01-29 | Policy / copyright         | U.S. Copyright Office    | The U.S. Copyright Office published Part 2 of its AI report on copyrightability of AI outputs.                         | Human-authorship rules affect generated content, practice tools and creator workflows.                            | High       | A          |
| 2025-03-17 | Education network signal   | School of Rock           | School of Rock social channels referenced roughly 400 global locations.                                                | Offline music schools remain scaled trust and accountability channels.                                            | Medium     | B          |
| 2025-04-10 | Artist platform            | TikTok for Artists beta  | Coverage indicated TikTok was preparing a dedicated artist insights platform before global launch.                     | TikTok is formalizing the data layer around music discovery.                                                      | Medium     | B          |
| 2025-04-28 | M&A / creator tools        | Splice / Spitfire Audio  | Splice announced the acquisition of Spitfire Audio.                                                                    | Creator-tool platforms are consolidating premium sound libraries for AI-assisted creation.                        | High       | A          |
| 2025-05-01 | Education platform         | Berklee Online           | Berklee Online positioned itself as the world's largest online music school with 30,000+ learners from 140+ countries. | High-trust online music education offers a benchmark for credentialed, instructor-led learning.                   | High       | A          |
| 2025-06-03 | Artist insights            | TikTok for Artists       | TikTok for Artists launched globally after beta testing, initially in 26 countries.                                    | TikTok is becoming structured music analytics and promotion infrastructure.                                       | High       | A          |
| 2025-08-01 | AI music generation        | ElevenLabs Music         | ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music generation.                                                    | Major voice/audio AI providers moved into full music creation.                                                    | High       | A          |
| 2025-08-20 | AI practice / creation     | Moises AI Studio         | Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation support.                                                      | Practice utilities are expanding toward creation co-pilots.                                                       | High       | A          |
| 2025-09-25 | AI governance              | Spotify                  | Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and songwriters.                                                 | Streaming-platform AI rules shape discovery, identity and rights expectations.                                    | High       | A          |
| 2025-09-30 | Funding call               | Creative Europe MEDIA    | The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call opened.                                                    | Interactive learning, gamified practice or immersive music products may fit future EU creative funding routes.    | High       | A          |
| 2025-10-02 | Product launch             | Splice INSTRUMENT        | Splice moved beyond samples with a cloud-connected instrument plugin drawing on Spitfire libraries.                    | Creator platforms are reducing friction from inspiration to playable sound.                                       | Medium     | B          |

| Date       | Move Type                  | Player Or Signal                       | What Happened                                                                                                        | Why It Matters For Yousician                                                                                                                      | Confidence | News Grade |
|------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|
| 2025-10-22 | Youth performance          | School of Rock / Warped Tour           | School of Rock locations announced student performers at Warped Tour Orlando.                                        | Performance-based learning connects lessons with youth culture and live music moments.                                                            | Medium     | B          |
| 2025-10-29 | AI rights / licensing      | UMG / Udio                             | UMG and Udio settled litigation and announced agreements for a licensed AI music creation platform planned for 2026. | A licensed AI music lane is emerging alongside litigation.                                                                                        | High       | A          |
| 2025-11-19 | Funding / AI music         | Suno                                   | Suno raised a \$250M Series C at a \$2.45B post-money valuation.                                                     | AI music generation has crossed into large-scale venture-backed consumer infrastructure.                                                          | High       | A          |
| 2025-11-25 | AI rights / partnership    | Warner Music Group / Suno              | Warner Music Group and Suno announced a partnership and settlement path for licensed AI models.                      | Major labels are beginning to define opt-in licensed AI models, not only legal opposition.                                                        | High       | A          |
| 2025-12-03 | Artist data                | Spotify Wrapped for Artists            | Spotify provided personalized Wrapped experiences for artists, songwriters, creators and advertisers.                | Music platforms are expanding shareable analytics loops around identity and fandom.                                                               | High       | A          |
| 2025-12-10 | Cultural signal            | TikTok Year in Music                   | TikTok named global 2025 music signals and highlighted Add to Music App behavior.                                    | Short-form music demand increasingly predicts what users may want to sing, play or learn.                                                         | High       | A          |
| 2025-12-14 | Award / EdTech             | WorldWIDE EdTech Awards                | The 2026 WorldWIDE EdTech Awards nomination deadline closed.                                                         | Education awards provide low-cost credibility routes if evidence of learning impact is documented.                                                | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-01-07 | Funding deadline           | EIC Accelerator                        | The first 2026 EIC Accelerator full-application cut-off occurred.                                                    | Public deep-tech funding remains relevant for high-risk AI practice or learning innovations.                                                      | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-01-22 | Investor thesis            | Menlo Ventures / Suno                  | Menlo framed Suno as participatory music creation in its Series C thesis.                                            | Venture theses are shifting from music consumption to participatory creation.                                                                     | High       | A          |
| 2026-02-06 | Award deadline             | Webby Awards                           | The 30th Annual Webby Awards extended entry deadline closed.                                                         | Apps, software, immersive and creator categories are relevant for brand and product recognition.                                                  | High       | A          |
| 2026-02-11 | Funding deadline           | Creative Europe MEDIA                  | The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call deadline closed.                                         | Music-learning/game-like products need early planning for EU creative funding cycles.                                                             | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-02-17 | Funding result             | EIC Accelerator                        | 61 startups and SMEs secured EIC Accelerator support in the latest round.                                            | EU deep-tech funding remains competitive but meaningful for high-risk innovation.                                                                 | High       | A          |
| 2026-03-01 | Awards / education         | EdTech Awards                          | The EdTech Awards 2026 announced finalists and winners in March 2026.                                                | Learning-product credibility can be strengthened through education technology awards.                                                             | High       | A          |
| 2026-03-15 | Rights / royalties         | Spotify Loud & Clear                   | Spotify's 2026 transparency reporting said 2025 payouts to the music industry exceeded \$11B.                        | Rights-holder economics affect catalog, artist relations and music-learning licensing context.                                                    | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-04-02 | AI awards                  | Tom's Guide AI Awards                  | Tom's Guide AI Awards nominations closed for 2026.                                                                   | Consumer AI awards are useful external signals for AI utility positioning.                                                                        | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-04-15 | AI creator tools           | Splice                                 | Splice announced generative AI tools tied to its creator compensation model.                                         | Human-made licensed sample catalogs are being combined with traceable generative workflows.                                                       | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-04-20 | Award opening              | Brandon Hall EdTech Awards             | The Excellence in EdTech Awards launched for 2026 entries with a September deadline.                                 | Operationally relevant award for learning products with measurable outcomes.                                                                      | High       | A          |
| 2026-04-30 | Platform growth            | YouTube Music / Premium                | Alphabet reported record quarterly growth for YouTube Music and Premium non-trial subscribers.                       | YouTube remains central to hobby music discovery, lessons, creators and paid music consumption.                                                   | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-05-01 | Developer ecosystem        | Google Play                            | Google Play summarized Q1 2026 discovery and developer tools updates.                                                | App-store discovery and merchandising remain important for music-learning acquisition.                                                            | High       | A          |
| 2026-05-18 | Awards / iOS               | Apple Design Awards                    | Apple announced 2026 Apple Design Award finalists.                                                                   | Apple design recognition remains a benchmark for app craft, accessibility and interaction.                                                        | High       | A          |
| 2026-05-22 | Creator / hardware culture | Rick Beato / Gibson / Nuno Bettencourt | Guitar media highlighted Rick Beato's live collaboration at Six-String Sanctuary and use of signature Gibson gear.   | Creator educators increasingly bridge learning, artist culture and hardware marketing.                                                            | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-06-01 | App accelerator            | Google Play Apps Accelerator           | Google Play announced the first Apps Accelerator class of 2026.                                                      | Platform accelerator programs are a route for app growth, merchandising and developer relationships.                                              | High       | A          |
| 2026-06-03 | Funding / public RDI       | Business Finland                       | Business Finland funding listings showed open R&D and internationalization funding routes.                           | As a Finnish company, Yousician can screen public RDI funding against product and AI initiatives.                                                 | High       | A          |
| 2026-06-03 | Funding / AI music         | Suno                                   | Suno announced more than \$400M in Series D funding at a \$5.4B post-money valuation.                                | Strengthens Suno as the leading AI music-creation market signal and reinforces AI creation as a market-structure force, not only a feature trend. | High       | A          |
| 2026-06-05 | AI rights / labor          | AFM / UMG / WMG                        | The American Federation of Musicians sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing to Suno and Udio.                            | AI-rights exposure now includes session musician compensation and labor claims.                                                                   | Medium     | B          |

| Date       | Move Type                 | Player Or Signal           | What Happened                                                                                           | Why It Matters For Yousician                                                           | Confidence | News Grade |
|------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|
| 2026-06-08 | AI creation tooling       | BandLab SongStarter        | BandLab's help center updated SongStarter guidance for AI-generated song ideas.                         | Large creator communities are normalizing AI as a lightweight idea-generation layer.   | High       | A          |
| 2026-06-10 | Award / iOS               | Apple Design Awards        | Apple revealed 2026 Design Award winners across app and game categories.                                | Awards can reveal current interaction and visual-quality benchmarks for consumer apps. | High       | A          |
| 2026-06-10 | Hardware + AI software    | Fender Studio Pro / Moises | Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant. | Instrument brands are moving deeper into app, DAW and AI utility territory.            | Medium     | B          |
| 2026-06-10 | AI rights / platform data | Google / YouTube / Lyria   | Independent musicians sued Google over alleged use of YouTube-uploaded music for Lyria AI training.     | Creator-platform data rights are becoming material to AI music tooling and trust.      | Medium     | B          |

- AI companies and AI initiatives: 14
- Media, publishers and cultural drivers: 9
- Awards: 7
- Funding: 6
- Teachers, schools and music education organizations: 5
- Music hobby software ecosystem: 3
- Wider education and self-improvement ecosystem: 1
- Investors active in the space: 1
- Music learning apps and platforms: 1
- Influencers, creators and educators: 1
- Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors: 1

# Appfigures is an input note, not the market story

**Appfigures remains the required source for app revenue, downloads, rank trends, review velocity and country mix. Those fields are prepared for import and are not estimated in this package.**

16 app rows are ready for credentialed export/import; 0 credentialed rows are currently populated. Public app-store ratings or reviews are shown only as public proxies and must not be described as Appfigures.

The Appfigures data request is included separately. The main report therefore ranks by ecosystem influence, not app revenue/downloads.

# What can be strengthened without paid data

Free public sources can improve scale context, sentiment proxies, public-company financial scale, funding rounds and market events. They do not replace credentialed Appfigures for app performance.

## PUBLIC APP-STORE PROXY

### Apple iTunes Search / Lookup API

**Answers:** Public iOS app listing signal and consumer sentiment proxy

**Usable fields:** rating; rating\_count; app\_url; seller; category

**Limit:** Not revenue, downloads, rank trend, retention, country mix or Appfigures. Ratings can vary by storefront and timing.

**Next:** Keep refreshing as public proxy; never label as Appfigures.

## PUBLIC APP-STORE PROXY

### Google Play public app listing

**Answers:** Public Android listing signal and install-band proxy

**Usable fields:** rating; review\_count; install\_band; store\_url

**Limit:** No official open performance API for competitor listings. Install bands are coarse and page structure can change.

**Next:** Keep as coarse proxy; validate manually if a number will be cited externally.

## PUBLIC COMPANY FILINGS

### SEC EDGAR APIs

**Answers:** Financial scale and acquisition context for SEC-reporting public companies

**Usable fields:** revenue; segment notes; risk factors; M&A disclosures; annual filings

**Limit:** Only covers SEC-reporting entities and disclosed line items. Segment-level music or education detail may not exist.

**Next:** Use for Disney

## PUBLIC COMPANY FILINGS

### Company investor-relations annual reports

**Answers:** Financial scale and strategy from company-owned reporting

**Usable fields:** revenue; operating metrics; segment narrative; acquisition history

**Limit:** Company-defined segments can be broad; private competitors usually do not publish comparable data.

**Next:** Add official IR/annual-report links for every public company in the broader platform category.

## PUBLIC FUNDING DATABASE

### European Commission CORDIS / EU Funding and Tenders

**Answers:** Public R&D and grant-funded innovation signals

**Usable fields:** project; programme; grant; participants; topic; dates

**Limit:** Not a commercial market-size source. Useful for public funding and ecosystem signal only.

**Next:** Scan music learning

## OFFICIAL COMPANY/NEWS SOURCE

### Company press rooms and investor news

**Answers:** Funding rounds

**Usable fields:** acquisitions

**Limit:** Used in market\_moves\_24m\_curated\_v3\_2.csv and review-gated source audit

**Next:** Press releases are selective and promotional. Amounts and user figures need source confidence and review status.

# The direct learning-app market remains visible even while performance is not finalized

This snapshot keeps the core music-learning app field visible without inventing Appfigures metrics. It is qualitative until credentialed revenue, download, rank and country-mix data is imported.

| Player        | What They Are                                                                                      | Audience Focus                                  | Public Proxy Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Why It Matters                                                                                                          | Appfigures Status                                                           |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Simply        | Mobile-first music learning platform and direct reference point for casual learners.               | Beginner / casual learners                      | Simply Guitar - Learn Guitar: 4.72 iOS public proxy, 384,516 iOS public proxy   Google Play public proxy: 10M+ downloads, 4.6 rating, 360K reviews. Public proxy, not Appfigures. iTunes Lookup refreshed 2026-06-11; public proxy only, not Appfigures. Apple public proxy: 4.72 rating, 384,516 ratings as of 2026-06-22. Google Play public proxy: 10M+ installs band as of 2026-06-22. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.   Simply Piano: 4.69 iOS public proxy, 827,951 iOS public proxy   Needs Appfigures; include as Simply portfolio app. Public proxy, not Appfigures. iTunes Lookup refreshed 2026-06-11; public proxy only, not Appfigures. Apple public proxy: 4.69 rating, 827,951 ratings as of 2026-06-22. Google Play public proxy: 50M+ installs band as of 2026-06-22. Public proxy only, not Appfigures. | Useful benchmark for onboarding, motivation, pricing, and growth in app-based music education.                          | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Flowkey       | Piano learning app focused on songs, guided lessons, and practice support.                         | Beginner piano learners                         | flowkey - Learn to Play Piano: 4.72 iOS public proxy, 63,972 iOS public proxy   Apple public proxy: 4.7 rating, 64K ratings; Google Play public proxy: 10M+ learners claim in listing. Public proxy, not Appfigures. iTunes Lookup refreshed 2026-06-11; public proxy only, not Appfigures. Apple public proxy: 4.72 rating, 63,972 ratings as of 2026-06-22. Google Play public proxy: 5M+ installs band as of 2026-06-22. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Important benchmark for piano learning, catalog positioning, and conversion mechanics.                                  | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Skoove        | Digital piano learning platform for beginner and intermediate players.                             | Beginner piano learners                         | Skoove: Learn Piano: 4.58 iOS public proxy, 21,573 iOS public proxy   Google Play public proxy: 1M+ downloads, 11.6K reviews. Public proxy, not Appfigures. iTunes Lookup refreshed 2026-06-11; public proxy only, not Appfigures. Apple public proxy: 4.58 rating, 21,573 ratings as of 2026-06-22. Google Play public proxy: 1M+ installs band as of 2026-06-22. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Relevant for piano pedagogy, app store positioning, and paid acquisition benchmarks.                                    | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Fender Play   | Learning product connected to one of the strongest guitar brands.                                  | Beginner guitar and bass learners               | Fender Play: Learn Guitar: 4.80 iOS public proxy, 60,621 iOS public proxy   Apple public proxy: 4.8 rating, 61K ratings; Google Play public proxy: 1M+ downloads, 13.2K reviews. Public proxy, not Appfigures. iTunes Lookup refreshed 2026-06-11; public proxy only, not Appfigures. Apple public proxy: 4.80 rating, 60,621 ratings as of 2026-06-22. Google Play public proxy: 1M+ installs band as of 2026-06-22. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Shows how instrument makers can extend into software, subscriptions, and beginner journeys.                             | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Gibson App    | Guitar-learning app connected to Gibson's hardware and brand ecosystem.                            | Beginner guitar learners and Gibson customers   | Needs Appfigures and public app-store validation. Public proxy, not Appfigures. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Shows how a major guitar brand can bundle learning with instrument purchase and beginner motivation.                    | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Guitar Tricks | Long-running online guitar lesson platform with structured courses, songs, and learning tools.     | Guitar learners seeking structured lessons      | No public app-store proxy attached in this package; use Appfigures or store validation before performance comparison.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Important guitar-specific subscription benchmark for curriculum depth, song-led learning, and adult beginner messaging. | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Pickup Music  | Modern guitar-learning platform built around structured pathways and contemporary player identity. | Intermediate and style-specific guitar learners | No public app-store proxy attached in this package; use Appfigures or store validation before performance comparison.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Useful benchmark for higher-intent guitarists, modern aesthetics, community, and guided weekly practice.                | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Rocksmith+    | Interactive music-learning service built around real instruments, song catalog, and feedback.      | Practice-oriented guitar/piano learners         | Needs Appfigures plus Ubisoft platform data. Public proxy, not Appfigures. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Important benchmark for real-time feedback, licensed songs, game-like practice, and multi-instrument expansion.         | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Musora        | Umbrella music education platform spanning drums, piano, guitar, singing, lessons, and community.  | Multi-instrument learners                       | Needs Appfigures plus web membership validation. Public proxy, not Appfigures. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Adds an important multi-instrument subscription benchmark beyond single-instrument apps.                                | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |
| Fretello      | Mobile guitar learning app focused on structured plans and guided practice.                        | Beginner and returning guitar learners          | Needs Appfigures; specialist guitar-learning app. Public proxy, not Appfigures. Public proxy only, not Appfigures.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Directly relevant for guitar onboarding, lesson pacing, personalization, and app-store positioning.                     | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |

| Player         | What They Are                                        | Audience Focus                | Public Proxy Evidence                                                                                                 | Why It Matters                                                               | Appfigures Status                                                           |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Duolingo Music | Consumer education app extension into music literacy | Mass-market beginner learners | No public app-store proxy attached in this package; use Appfigures or store validation before performance comparison. | Direct reference point for app-based music learning and beginner motivation. | Credentialed Appfigures data pending; no revenue/download/rank conclusions. |

# Teachers, creators, investors, media, awards and funding

## Teachers / schools

17

Education bodies and teacher networks shape trust, progression, certification language and parent confidence.

## Creators

26

Creator educators influence discovery, trust and beginner motivation. Platform reach remains partly pending.

## Investors

22

Capital flows around music, education, creator tools and AI indicate adjacent market momentum.

## Media / culture

28

Media, platforms and cultural drivers explain demand formation before app consideration.

## Awards

12

Award entries are now usable as an operational tracker with fit, timing and effort fields.

## Funding

12

Funding opportunities are separated from investors and marked by geography, eligibility and effort.

# Four priority actors in a closer brief-style one-pager format

These profile pages mirror the field logic from the brief example: what they are, why they matter, business snapshot, product surface, AI initiatives, last 24 months, ecosystem position, relationship field, strategic assessment and sources. The long tail remains in the workbook for triage, not as profile workload.

KP-01 / MUSIC LEARNING APPS AND PLATFORMS

Pending

## Simply

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>WHAT THEY ARE</b></p> <p>Mobile-first music learning platform and direct reference point for casual learners.</p>                                                                                                      | <p><b>WHY THEY MATTER</b></p> <p>Useful benchmark for onboarding, motivation, pricing, and growth in app-based music education.</p>           |
| <p><b>BUSINESS SNAPSHOT</b></p> <p>Publicly visible consumer app; precise reach requires Appfigures or traffic validation.</p> <p><i>Public app-store proxy is attached in the workbook; Appfigures remains pending.</i></p> | <p><b>PRODUCT PORTFOLIO / SURFACE</b></p> <p>Direct learning app</p>                                                                          |
| <p><b>AI INITIATIVES</b></p> <p>AI/personalization relevance should be validated before being treated as a product claim.</p>                                                                                                | <p><b>LAST 24 MONTHS</b></p> <p>No main-timeline recent-news item used for this profile; source monitoring remains active.</p>                |
| <p><b>ECOSYSTEM POSITION</b></p> <p>Music learning apps and platforms</p>                                                                                                                                                    | <p><b>RELATIONSHIP WITH YOUSICIAN</b></p> <p>Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.</p> |
| <p><b>STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT</b></p> <p>Credentialed Appfigures data is pending. Do not use this row for revenue, downloads, rank trend, review velocity, country mix or app-performance ranking.</p>                          | <p><b>SOURCES</b></p> <p><a href="https://www.hellosimply.com/simply-guitar">https://www.hellosimply.com/simply-guitar</a></p>                |

# Ultimate Guitar

WHAT THEY ARE

Tab, chord, song, and musician community ecosystem for guitar players.

BUSINESS SNAPSHOT

Large global music community  
*Public app-store proxy is attached in the workbook; Appfigures remains pending.*

AI INITIATIVES

Research AI-assisted discovery, practice, and content workflow signals

ECOSYSTEM POSITION

Music hobby software ecosystem

STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT

Credentialed Appfigures data is pending. Do not use this row for revenue, downloads, rank trend, review velocity, country mix or app-performance ranking.

WHY THEY MATTER

Strong influence on how hobbyists discover songs and move from inspiration to practice.

PRODUCT PORTFOLIO / SURFACE

Song-practice ecosystem

LAST 24 MONTHS

No main-timeline recent-news item used for this profile; source monitoring remains active.

RELATIONSHIP WITH YOUSICIAN

Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

SOURCES

<https://www.ultimate-guitar.com/about/>

# Duolingo

WHAT THEY ARE

Consumer learning benchmark for habit formation, gamification, and subscription education.

BUSINESS SNAPSHOT

Very large public consumer education app

AI INITIATIVES

AI personalization and tutoring relevance should be validated before high-stakes use.

ECOSYSTEM POSITION

Teachers, schools and music education organizations / wider education

STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT

No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

WHY THEY MATTER

Not music-specific, but highly relevant for learning loops, retention, brand, and AI in education.

PRODUCT PORTFOLIO / SURFACE

Consumer learning benchmark

LAST 24 MONTHS

2024-09-25: Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.

RELATIONSHIP WITH YOUSICIAN

Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

SOURCES

<https://investors.duolingo.com/investor-relations>

# Fender

WHAT THEY ARE

Iconic guitar brand with reach across aspiration, hardware, education, and artist culture.

WHY THEY MATTER

Instrument brands can shape the beginner funnel before users choose a learning app.

BUSINESS SNAPSHOT

Major global brand

PRODUCT PORTFOLIO / SURFACE

Hardware ecosystem

AI INITIATIVES

Research connected instrument and practice feedback initiatives

LAST 24 MONTHS

2026-06-10: Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and a smart studio assistant.

ECOSYSTEM POSITION

Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors

RELATIONSHIP WITH YOUSICIAN

Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT

No app-performance row mapped; add if app-based.

SOURCES

<https://www.fender.com/play>

# Open data fields before broader external use

Appendix

### Appfigures

Open until credentialed export/API data is imported. No app-performance ranking should be finalized.

### Source-linked statements

157 statement rows retain source confidence for broader use.

### Relationships

Internal relationship status not yet captured in this dataset. To be completed by Yousician.

### Source review

80 source-change items and 78 access rows remain open in the appendix.

| Check Id               | Label                                  | Status  | Count | Detail                                                                                  | Next Action                                                                                              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| key_players            | Initial 4 key players present          | passed  | 4     | 4 first-pass key-player rows are present.                                               | Keep the shortlist at Simply, Ultimate Guitar, Duolingo and Fender until board/LST triage expands scope. |
| market_moves           | Main timeline depth                    | passed  | 49    | 49 curated market moves are marked for main timeline use.                               | Keep weaker context items in appendix-only status.                                                       |
| appfigures             | Credentialed Appfigures status         | pending | 0     | 0 of 16 app rows are credentialed Appfigures imports.                                   | Import a credentialed Appfigures export or API output. Non credentialed rows do not count.               |
| appfigures_request     | Appfigures data request                | passed  | 16    | 16 app rows are ready for credentialed export.                                          | Use the data request as the source list for Appfigures export.                                           |
| relationships          | Relationship input field               | pending | 28    | 28 of 28 relationship rows still need Yousician owner input.                            | Do not infer relationships externally; assign internal owners.                                           |
| review_queue           | Open source-change review queue        | warning | 80    | 80 source-change/new-source rows remain open after excluding refresh retry/access rows. | Review or reject source changes before leadership use.                                                   |
| refresh_retries        | Refresh retry/access rows              | warning | 78    | 78 open rows are local refresh retry/access checks, not accepted market claims.         | Retry when network/source access is available or replace inaccessible sources.                           |
| review_duplicates      | Duplicate open refresh rows            | warning | 80    | 36 sources have repeated open refresh rows.                                             | Safe fix marks older duplicate rows as superseded and keeps the latest row open.                         |
| public_note_duplicates | Repeated non credentialed source notes | passed  | 0     | 0 Appfigures rows contain repeated non credentialed note text.                          | Safe fix de-duplicates repeated note sentences without changing metrics.                                 |
| source_context         | Source-linked statement confidence     | warning | 33    | 33 source-linked statements still have Low/Pending source confidence.                   | Validate ownership, funding, user counts, AI and M&A statements before broader external use.             |
| source_confidence      | Source audit confidence                | warning | 32    | 32 source-audit rows are Low/Pending.                                                   | Upgrade only with stronger source review; do not auto-promote.                                           |

# Source context and remaining open data fields

Appendix

Source context mix: {'Pending': 12, 'Low': 20, 'High': 76, 'Medium': 98}. The full source appendix remains in the database and CSV appendix.

| Gap                                   | Status                                                            | Detail                                                                                                                                                                         | Priority | Next Action                                                                                                                                                         | Owner Placeholder                       |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Appfigures metrics                    | Pending / credentialed export required                            | Revenue, downloads, ranks, ratings velocity, country mix and 12-month trends remain pending unless populated from a credentialed Appfigures export.                            | Critical | Export the Appfigures data request and import the credentialed Appfigures export.                                                                                   | Yousician / Appfigures credential owner |
| Internal relationship status          | Pending / internal owner input required                           | Internal relationship ownership, history and sensitivity fields are prepared for Yousician input and must be filled only from confirmed internal knowledge.                    | Critical | Assigned Yousician owners fill relationship owner, status, sensitivity and last-contact fields.                                                                     | Yousician owners                        |
| Private company ownership and revenue | Partially validated / paid database or direct validation required | Public source status is captured, but ownership, investor history and revenue for private players require Crunchbase, PitchBook, Dealroom or direct validation.                | High     | Run a paid-database validation pass for private companies before investor or leadership usage.                                                                      | Research owner TBD                      |
| Influencer multi-platform reach       | Partially complete / platform export required                     | YouTube reach is included where visible. TikTok, Instagram and average views remain marked as pending platform export for campaign planning.                                   | High     | Use YouTube/TikTok/Instagram channel exports or creator tools to fill current reach and average-view fields.                                                        | Creator/partnership owner TBD           |
| Traffic and SEO                       | Pending / Similarweb or analytics-grade export required           | Web traffic for song/practice ecosystems, teacher platforms and media drivers requires Similarweb or a comparable analytics export.                                            | Medium   | Run Similarweb export for priority domains and label it as public/third-party traffic estimate.                                                                     | Research owner TBD                      |
| Awards and funding deadlines          | Operationalized / quarterly refresh needed                        | Awards and funding rows now contain deadlines, effort, fit and immediate next steps; date cycles should still be refreshed quarterly.                                          | Low      | Review deadlines at the start of each quarter and assign an ops/comms owner before submission decisions.                                                            | Ops / comms owner TBD                   |
| User research linkage                 | Pending / Confluence research-database access required            | Market signals should be linked back to Yousician user research before turning observations into recommendations. This pass does not have Confluence research database access. | Medium   | Search the Yousician User Research Database for guitar beginner motivation, FTUX, churn, pricing and competitor studies and add study links to the report appendix. | Research / strategy owner TBD           |

## Source-linked observation sample

| Entity                  | Statement Type        | Statement                                                                                                                       | Source Confidence | Main Narrative Rule                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moises                  | Ownership / investors | Private                                                                                                                         | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Pickup Music            | Ownership / investors | Pickup Music, Inc.                                                                                                              | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Suno / Udio / RIAA      | Market move           | 2024-06-24: Major record companies filed copyright infringement cases against Suno and Udio.                                    | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| European Union AI Act   | Market move           | 2024-08-01: The EU AI Act entered into force, with transparency rules for AI-generated content and GPAI obligations phasing in. | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| TikTok Music            | Market move           | 2024-09-24: TikTok announced it would shut down TikTok Music and focus on music discovery in the main TikTok app.               | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Duolingo / Loog         | Market move           | 2024-09-25: Duolingo Music was linked to a beginner-friendly portable piano product with Loog.                                  | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| YouTube Dream Track     | Market move           | 2024-11-12: YouTube tested AI restyling of licensed songs for Shorts using Dream Track technology.                              | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Microsoft TakeLessons   | Market move           | 2024-11-15: Microsoft's TakeLessons marketplace closed, with account access ending in November 2024.                            | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Music.AI / Moises       | Market move           | 2025-01-22: Music.AI raised a \$40M Series A and reported Moises at 50M users.                                                  | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| U.S. Copyright Office   | Market move           | 2025-01-29: The U.S. Copyright Office published Part 2 of its AI report on copyrightability of AI outputs.                      | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| School of Rock          | Market move           | 2025-03-17: School of Rock social channels referenced roughly 400 global locations.                                             | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Splice / Spitfire Audio | Market move           | 2025-04-28: Splice announced the acquisition of Spitfire Audio.                                                                 | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |

| Entity                      | Statement Type | Statement                                                                                                                        | Source Confidence | Main Narrative Rule                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TikTok for Artists          | Market move    | 2025-06-03: TikTok for Artists launched globally after beta testing, initially in 26 countries.                                  | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| ElevenLabs Music            | Market move    | 2025-08-01: ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music generation.                                                  | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Moises AI Studio            | Market move    | 2025-08-20: Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation support.                                                    | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Spotify                     | Market move    | 2025-09-25: Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and songwriters.                                               | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Creative Europe MEDIA       | Market move    | 2025-09-30: The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call opened.                                                  | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Splice INSTRUMENT           | Market move    | 2025-10-02: Splice moved beyond samples with a cloud-connected instrument plugin drawing on Spitfire libraries.                  | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| UMG / Udio                  | Market move    | 2025-10-29: UMG and Udio settled litigation and announced agreements for a licensed AI music creation platform planned for 2026. | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Suno                        | Market move    | 2025-11-19: Suno raised a \$250M Series C at a \$2.45B post-money valuation.                                                     | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Warner Music Group / Suno   | Market move    | 2025-11-25: Warner Music Group and Suno announced a partnership and settlement path for licensed AI models.                      | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Spotify Wrapped for Artists | Market move    | 2025-12-03: Spotify provided personalized Wrapped experiences for artists, songwriters, creators and advertisers.                | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| TikTok Year in Music        | Market move    | 2025-12-10: TikTok named global 2025 music signals and highlighted Add to Music App behavior.                                    | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| WorldWIDE EdTech Awards     | Market move    | 2025-12-14: The 2026 WorldWIDE EdTech Awards nomination deadline closed.                                                         | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| EIC Accelerator             | Market move    | 2026-01-07: The first 2026 EIC Accelerator full-application cut-off occurred.                                                    | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Webby Awards                | Market move    | 2026-02-06: The 30th Annual Webby Awards extended entry deadline closed.                                                         | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| Creative Europe MEDIA       | Market move    | 2026-02-11: The 2026 Video Games and Immersive Content Development call deadline closed.                                         | Medium            | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |
| EdTech Awards               | Market move    | 2026-03-01: The EdTech Awards 2026 announced finalists and winners in March 2026.                                                | High              | May be used in the main narrative with source URL and confidence visible; final source skim recommended before external leadership/investor use. |

Open statements requiring final validation sample

| Entity          | Statement Type        | Statement                                                                     | Source Confidence | Open Reason                                                   |
|-----------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Simply          | Ownership / investors | Simply Ltd                                                                    | Pending           | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Ultimate Guitar | Ownership / investors | Muse Group                                                                    | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Fender Play     | Ownership / investors | Fender                                                                        | Pending           | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Flowkey         | Ownership / investors | flowkey GmbH; Yamaha is a hardware-promotion partner, not shown here as owner | Pending           | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| JustinGuitar    | Ownership / investors | Independent                                                                   | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Fender          | Ownership / investors | Private                                                                       | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Yamaha          | Ownership / investors | Public company                                                                | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| BandLab         | Ownership / investors | BandLab Technologies                                                          | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Splice          | Ownership / investors | Private                                                                       | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Suno            | Ownership / investors | Private                                                                       | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Udio            | Ownership / investors | Private                                                                       | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Duolingo        | Ownership / investors | Public company                                                                | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |

| Entity              | Statement Type        | Statement          | Source Confidence | Open Reason                                                   |
|---------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Guitar Tricks       | Ownership / investors | Guitar Tricks Inc. | Pending           | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Rocksmith+          | Ownership / investors | Ubisoft            | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Gibson App          | Ownership / investors | Gibson             | Pending           | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Chordify            | Ownership / investors | Chordify B.V.      | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| YouTube             | Ownership / investors | Google / Alphabet  | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Gibson              | Ownership / investors | Private            | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Positive Grid       | Ownership / investors | Private            | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| FL Studio           | Ownership / investors | Image-Line         | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| ElevenLabs Music    | Ownership / investors | Private            | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |
| Spotify for Artists | Ownership / investors | Spotify            | Low               | Pending until source confidence is upgraded from Low/Pending. |

# Appendix-only market moves

Appendix

| Date       | Move Type                 | Player Or Signal | What Happened                                                                                                 | Curation Note                                             | Confidence | News Grade |
|------------|---------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|
| 2024-06-20 | Product / guitar learning | Rocksmith+       | Rocksmith+ continued cross-platform subscription positioning for learning real songs with real instruments.   | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | Medium     | C          |
| 2024-07-15 | Practice utility          | Chord ai         | Chord ai public listings positioned AI chord, beat and song-structure recognition as a play-any-song utility. | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | Medium     | C          |
| 2025-02-01 | Creator community         | BandLab          | BandLab continued to present itself as a 100M+ creator and fan platform.                                      | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | High       | C          |
| 2025-06-01 | Teacher network           | Lessonface       | Lessonface continued positioning as a marketplace for vetted online music teachers and live lessons.          | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | Medium     | C          |
| 2025-07-01 | Practice ecosystem        | MuseScore        | MuseScore public app listings emphasized interactive sheet music, tabs and large score access.                | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | Medium     | C          |
| 2025-09-01 | Creator education         | Pianote / Musora | Musora education brands continued to scale YouTube-led funnels for piano, drums, guitar and voice.            | Useful context, but weaker as a 'who made the news' item. | Medium     | C          |